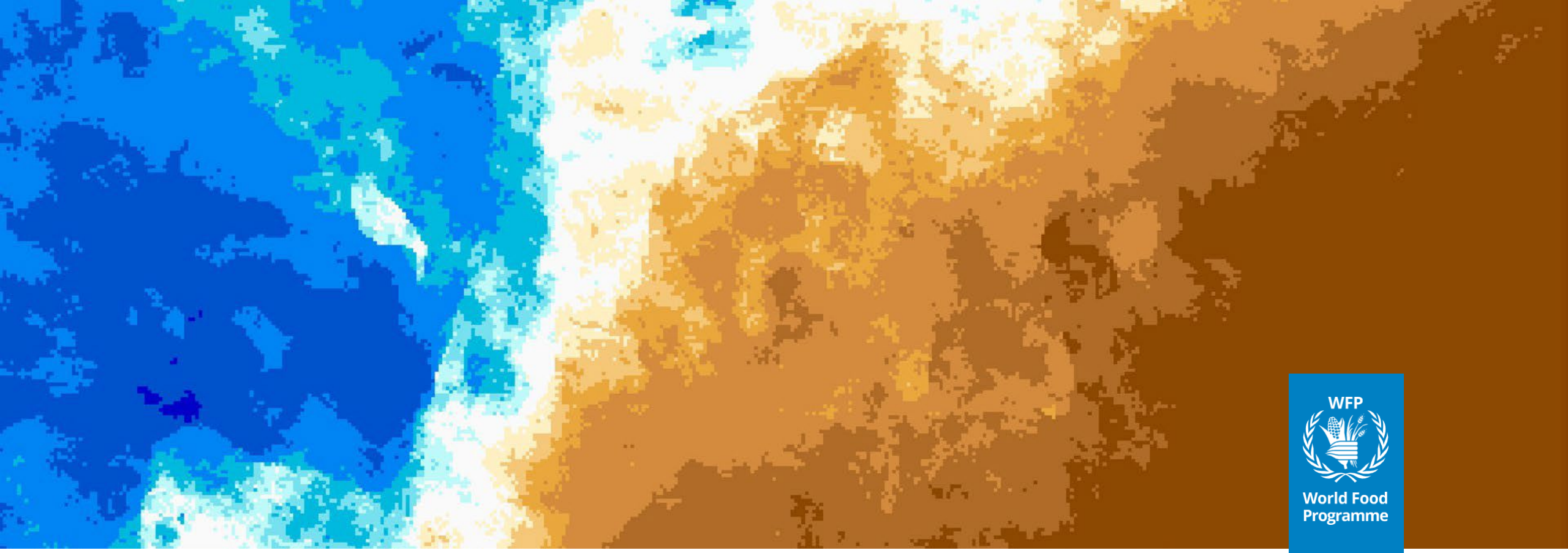


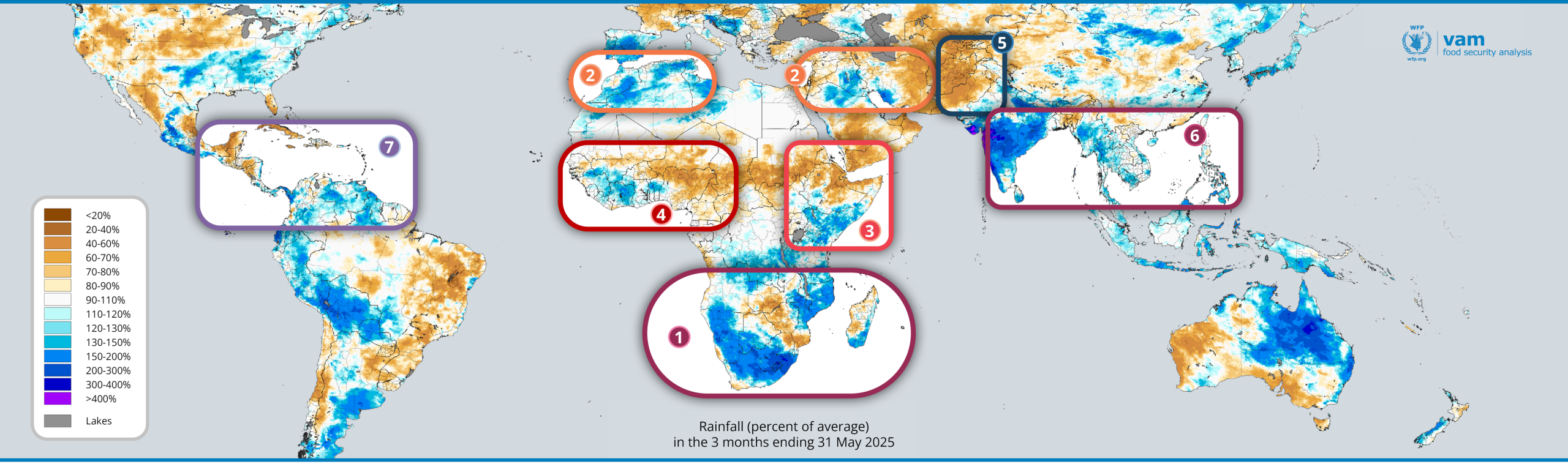
WFP
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Global Seasonal Outlook

May 2025



Rainfall (percent of average)
in the 3 months ending 31 May 2025

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

ENSO OUTLOOK

ENSO-neutral conditions are likely to continue through the summer.

1 SOUTHERN AFRICA

Improved rains since January have lifted crop prospects, putting most areas on course for a reasonable harvest. Food security is set to improve in 2025, despite some local challenges.

2 MENA REGION

drought

A harsh dry season is gripping the Maghreb, Syria, and Iraq, intensifying water shortages and putting crop production at serious risk.

3 EAST AFRICA

Improved rains are boosting crops across much of the Horn of Africa. While favorable weather forecasts through October should benefit crops, they also increase the risk of flooding in Sudan and Ethiopia and are likely to worsen the prolonged flooding in South Sudan.

4 WESTERN AFRICA

drought flood

Rainfall deficits likely to threat crops in the Gulf of Guinea and western Sahel, while flood risks rise in the east.

5 CENTRAL ASIA

drought

There are high concerns about prolonged dryness, especially in northern and northeastern Afghanistan. Reduced snowpack alongside elevated temperatures is expected to threaten irrigated spring and summer crops.

6 SE & S. E. ASIA

flood

Prospects for the coming monsoon season are favorable, but heavy rainfall and likely flooding in some regions remain a concern.

7 C. AMERICA & CARIBBEAN

drought cyclone

Below-average rainfall is forecast through August in the Dry Corridor and Caribbean, alongside an above-average hurricane season driven by warmer Atlantic waters.

SOUTHERN AFRICA

Seasonal Rainfall Calendar

Southern Africa

Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
■	■	■	■						■	■	■

Positive Crop Outlook Despite Rainfall Variability

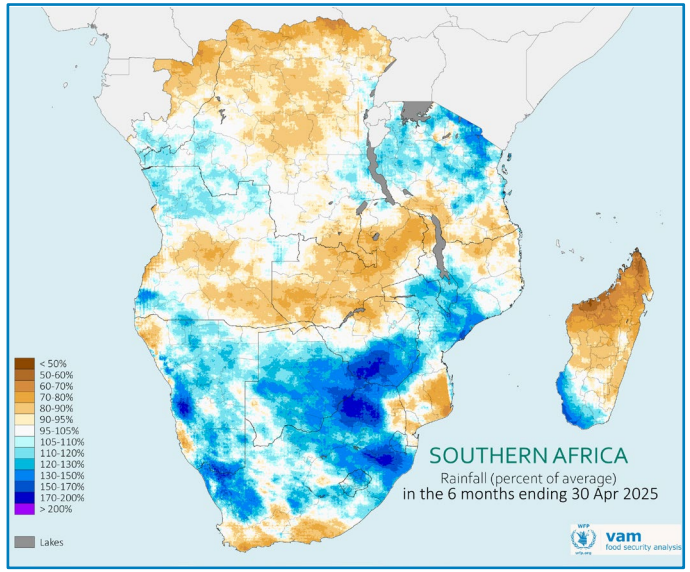
The 2024–2025 rainfall season in Southern Africa has concluded, characterized by significant spatial and temporal variability, with alternating wet and dry periods that have influenced the agricultural outlook across the region. Driven by weak La Niña conditions, the season was anticipated to bring improved rainfall and support recovery from the severe 2023–2024 El Niño-induced drought. While above-average rainfall was observed throughout April in most parts of the region, late-season improvements do not necessarily ensure crop recovery, particularly where early-season stress had already hindered development. The worst-performing seasonal rainfall was recorded in parts of Angola (eastern), Zambia, Madagascar (northern and eastern), Malawi (northern) and Zimbabwe (northern).

The season's onset was marked by an extended dry spell from October to December 2024, delaying planting and hindering early crop development across much of the region. Rainfall deficits during this critical period were especially severe in Angola, Zambia, Zimbabwe, and central Mozambique. Conditions improved considerably in January and February, with widespread rainfall supporting replanting efforts and vegetation growth, preventing extensive crop failures. However, localized excessive rainfall, exacerbated by Tropical Cyclone Jude in March, led to flooding and substantial damage to infrastructure and crops in Mozambique, Malawi, and parts of Zimbabwe. Increased moisture also heightened pest pressures, notably Fall Armyworm outbreaks in eastern Zambia, central Malawi, and northern Mozambique.

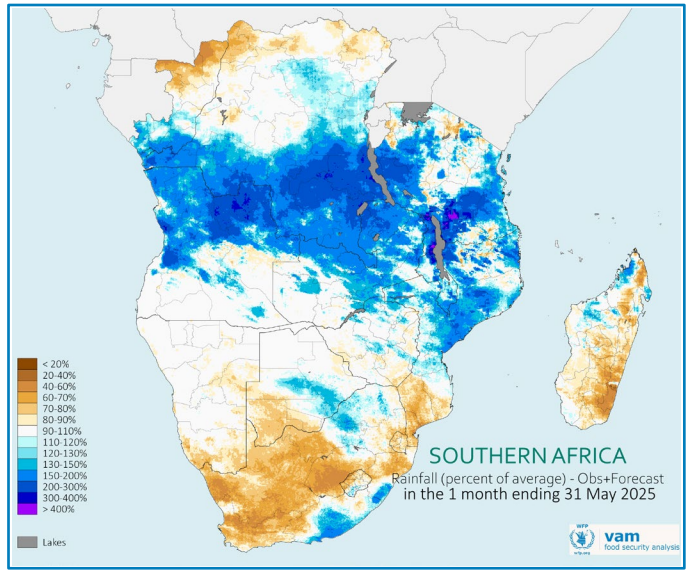
March brought a return to drier conditions across central and southern regions, raising concerns about the development of late-planted crops. Above-average rains in April have somewhat alleviated stress on maturing crops, but recovery remains uneven.

Despite some localized stress and variability, the overall seasonal outlook remains positive. While harvests may be delayed and crop quality mixed, total cereal production is expected to be slightly below or close to the regional average. However, early-season dryness is likely to result in reduced crop performance in parts of Angola, Mozambique, Zambia, and Malawi. South Africa, the region's largest maize producer, estimates its 2025 production to be 14% higher than last year recovering to near-average levels.

For a deeper dive into the details, check out the **Regional Food Security Outlook** *from WFP, FAO and SADC*



Rainfall from **November 2024** to **April 2025**, as a proportion of the long-term average. Blue and purple (orange and brown) shades correspond to above (below) average rainfall



Observed and forecast rainfall for the 1-month **until 31 May 2025**, as a proportion of the long-term average. Blue and purple (orange and brown) shades correspond to above (below) average rainfall

MENA REGION

Seasonal Rainfall Calendar

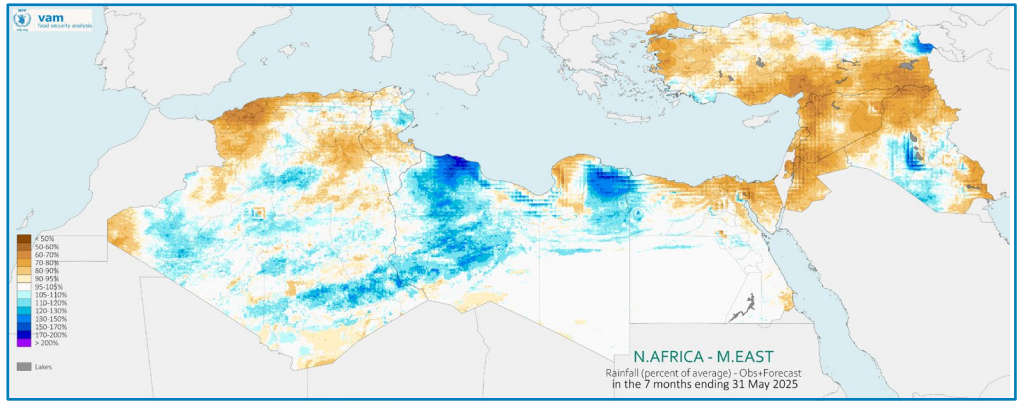
	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
Mena Region												

Rainfall Deficits and Rising Water Stress

The 2024–2025 rainfall season across the Middle East and North Africa (MENA) region has been marked by persistent and widespread rainfall deficits. Although some areas, particularly northern Jordan, parts of Iraq, and western Syria, experienced temporary improvements in precipitation during February and early March, these episodes were short-lived and insufficient to compensate for the overall seasonal dryness observed throughout much of the region.

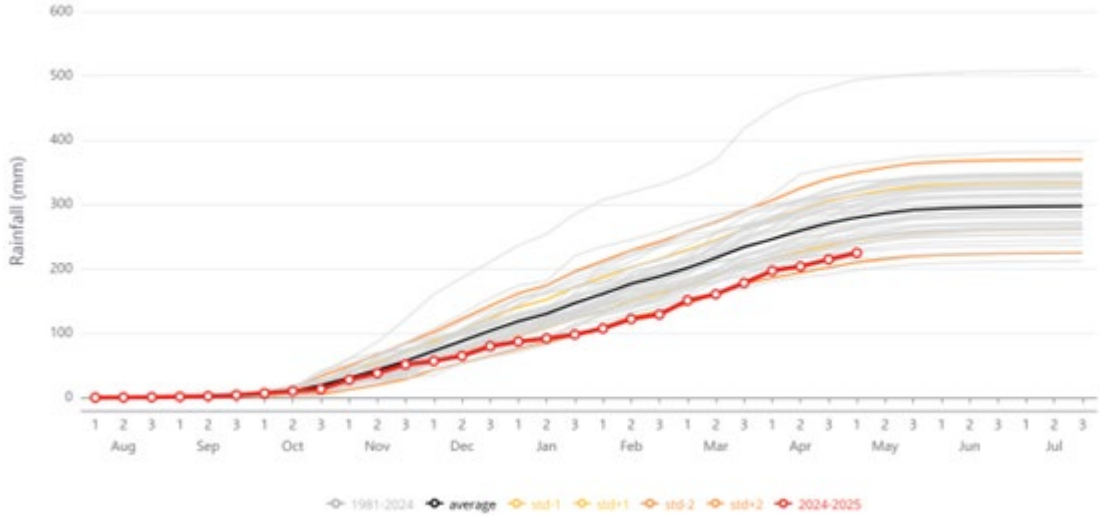
As the rainy season draws to a close, it is increasingly evident that below-average rainfall conditions have likely affected large agricultural zones in Iraq, Syria, Lebanon, Libya, and Algeria. These deficits are expected to negatively impact crop yields, pasture regeneration, and water availability for both human consumption and livestock.

Key river systems and reservoirs, including the Tigris and Euphrates, remain at critically low levels, exacerbating challenges for irrigated agriculture and further straining urban and rural water supplies. The situation is particularly severe in areas already burdened by conflict, displacement, or chronic water scarcity, such as Syria, Iraq, and Jordan.



Observed and forecast rainfall Nov 2024 to **31 May 2025**, as a proportion of the long-term average. Blue and purple (orange and brown) shades correspond to above (below) average rainfall

The Tigris and Euphrates Basin supports extensive agricultural activities across Turkey, Syria, Iraq, and Iran. Current data shows that cumulative basins rainfall is well below the historical average and tracking near 45 years historical lows.



Tigris - Euphrates - Accumulated rainfall amounts

EAST AFRICA — HORN OF AFRICA

Seasonal Rainfall Calendar

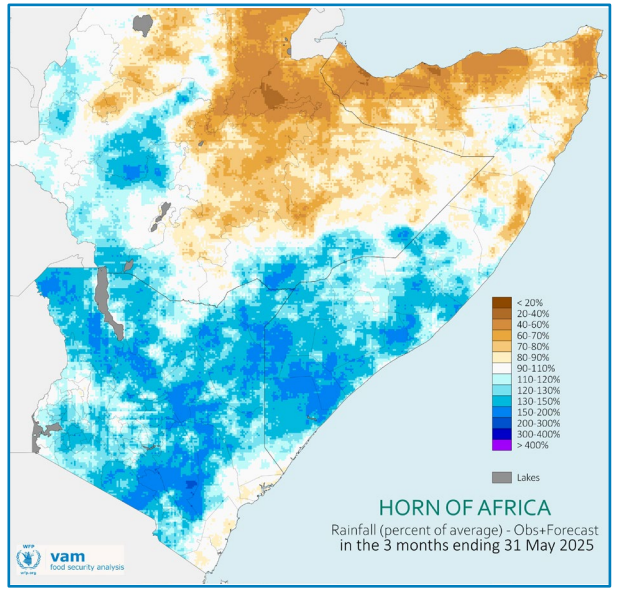
Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
		HOA Long Rains, Ethiopia (Belg)							HOA Short Rains		

Overall Favourable Season with Localized Dry Pockets

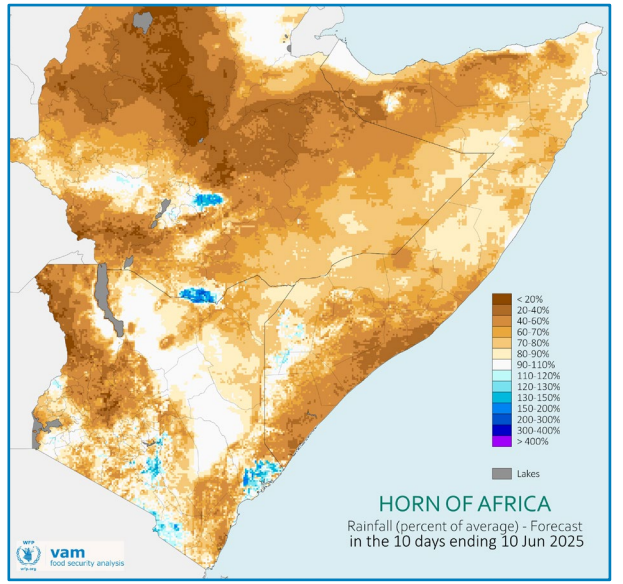
Despite earlier forecasts predicting a drier-than-average March–May 2025 Long Rains/Gu season—typical of La Niña patterns—the recent weakening of La Niña has led to generally favorable and well-distributed rainfall across much of the region. Some areas, such as Kenya and southern Somalia, have even experienced heavy rains, triggering localized flooding.

In contrast, Ethiopia's Belg season has produced mixed results, with near- to above-average rainfall in some areas, but below-average precipitation in parts of south-central Oromiya, northern Somali, and Afar. Northern Somalia is also facing below-average rainfall. These deficits are likely to impact crop production, pasture conditions, and water availability for livestock.

Although the season is nearing its end, the rainfall outlook through June 10 indicates generally dry conditions across the region, including Oromiya, Somali, and northern Somalia. This is concerning, particularly in areas where rains were brief and crops are still developing, as increasing dryness could reduce soil moisture and limit yields.



Observed and forecast rainfall for the 3-month **until 31 May 2025** (as a proportion of the long-term average. Blue and purple (orange and brown) shades for above (below) average rainfall



Forecast rainfall for the 10 days period ending **10 June 2025** as a proportion of the long-term average. Blue and purple (orange and brown) shades for above (below) average rainfall.

EAST AFRICA — SUDANS AND ETHIOPIA

Seasonal Rainfall Calendar

Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec

Eastern Africa
Sudans and Ethiopia (Meher)

Favourable Rains Ahead, But Flood Risks Rising

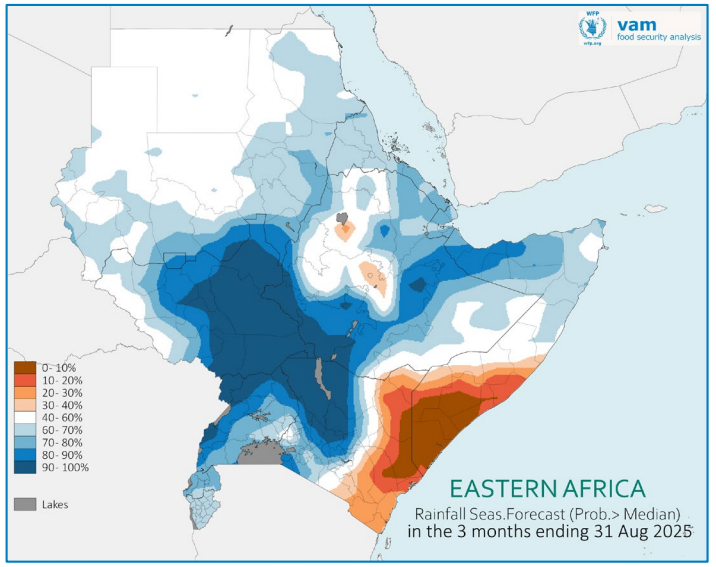
The season is still in its early phase, with the region experiencing variable rainfall in May. The overall short-term forecast for May indicates below-average rainfall in key areas such as southern Sudan, northern South Sudan, and central Ethiopia.

Seasonal forecasts for June to August 2025 indicate a strong likelihood of above-average rainfall across Uganda, western Kenya, Sudan, and South Sudan. This period aligns with the peak of the rainy season in these regions, potentially benefiting agriculture and water resources. However, it also increases the risk of flooding, particularly in vulnerable areas. This pattern reflects a continued multi-year trend of excessive rainfall, which has led to higher vegetation cover and exceptionally elevated water levels in major lakes, especially Lake Victoria, contributing to prolonged flooding in South Sudan's Sudd wetlands, and Lake Tanganyika, which has been the scene of recurrent flood events in the surrounding areas.

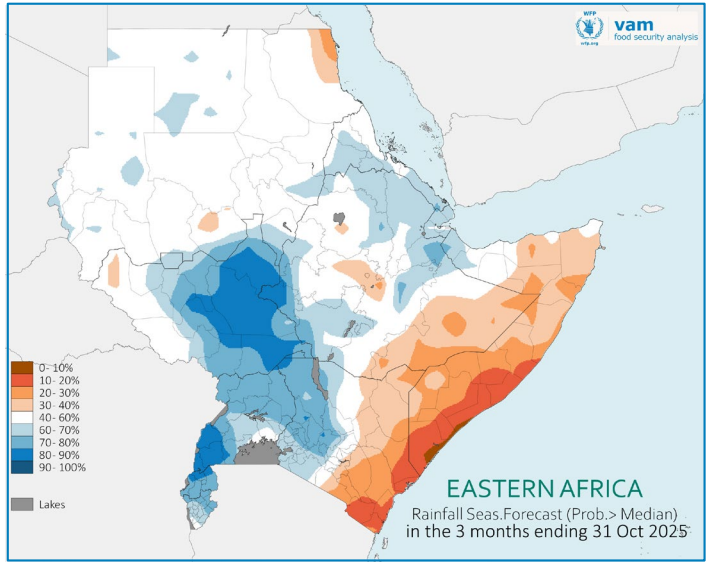
The forecast for August to October 2025 suggests that average to above-average rainfall will persist in South Sudan, eastern Ethiopia, western Kenya, Uganda, Burundi, and Rwanda. These conditions are expected to support crop growth and pasture regeneration but may also trigger further flooding. An additional concern is the timing of above-normal rains with the first season harvest in the bimodal zones of Uganda, Burundi, Rwanda, and parts of South Sudan, which could lead to significant post-harvest losses.

Given the likelihood of continued wetter-than-normal conditions, the probability of flooding remains high. Areas along the Nile and its tributaries in Sudan, as well as southwestern Ethiopia, are particularly vulnerable. South Sudan is expected to continue experiencing the effects of widespread multi-year flooding across its central and northern regions.

Flood events are likely to impact displaced populations in camps and disrupt logistic particularly in Sudan and South Sudan.



Rainfall forecast for the 3-month periods **Jun-Aug 2025** as the likelihood of exceeding the long-term median. Blue (orange) shades for likely wetter (drier) than usual conditions



Rainfall forecast for the 3-month periods **Aug-Oct 2025** as the likelihood of exceeding the long-term median. Blue (orange) shades for likely wetter (drier) than usual conditions

CENTRAL ASIA

Seasonal Rainfall Calendar

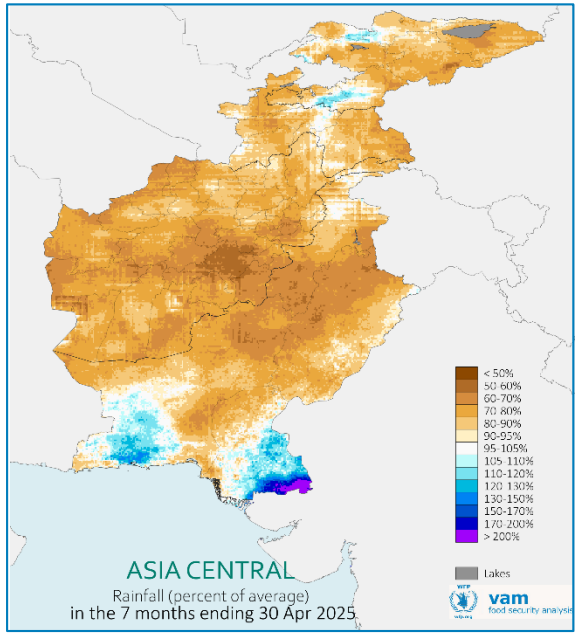
Central Asia

Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec

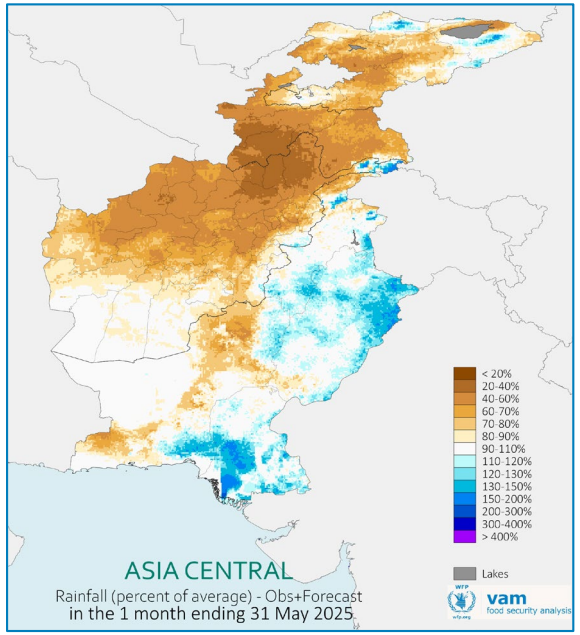
Season Wraps Up Dry, Generating Concerns for Crops and Water Supply

The winter season is drawing to a close across Central Asia, marked by widespread and persistent precipitation deficits. Among the countries most severely impacted is Afghanistan, where cumulative rainfall levels remain well below seasonal averages. Forecasts for the coming weeks suggest limited chances of meaningful rainfall, intensifying concerns about prolonged dryness, particularly in the northern and northeastern regions, which constitute the country's primary cereal producing zones.

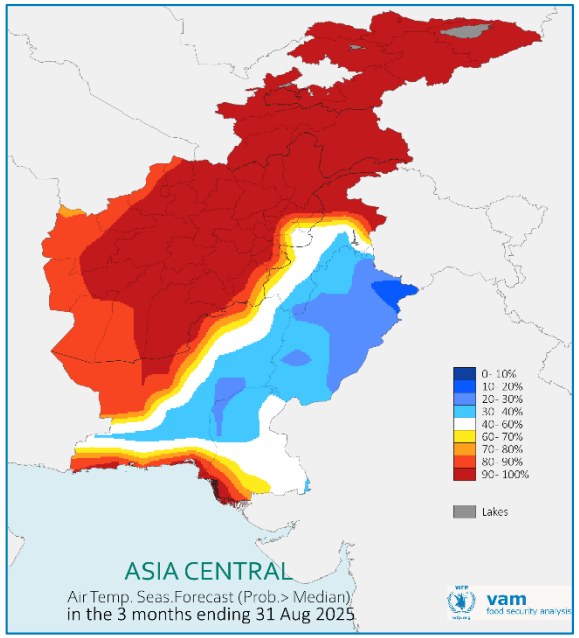
In addition to the ongoing rainfall deficits, snow accumulation has been well below average this season. Elevated temperatures have led to premature snowmelt, further reducing water availability for the upcoming spring and summer agricultural cycles. Forecasts indicate that above-average temperatures are likely to persist in the coming months, which will increase crop water requirements and elevate evapotranspiration rates, placing significant stress on irrigation-dependent crops. The combined impact of low precipitation, early snowmelt, and high temperatures is likely to significantly reduce crop yields and threaten food security.



Rainfall **October 2024** to **30 April 2025**, as a proportion of the long-term average. Blue and purple (orange and brown) shades correspond to above (below) average rainfall



Observed and forecast rainfall for the 1-month **until 31 May 2025**, as a proportion of the long-term average. Blue and purple (orange and brown) shades correspond to above (below) average rainfall



Temperature forecast for the 3-month **Jun-Aug 2025**. as the likelihood of exceeding the long-term median. Blue (red) shades for likely colder (hotter) than usual conditions

Seasonal Rainfall Calendar

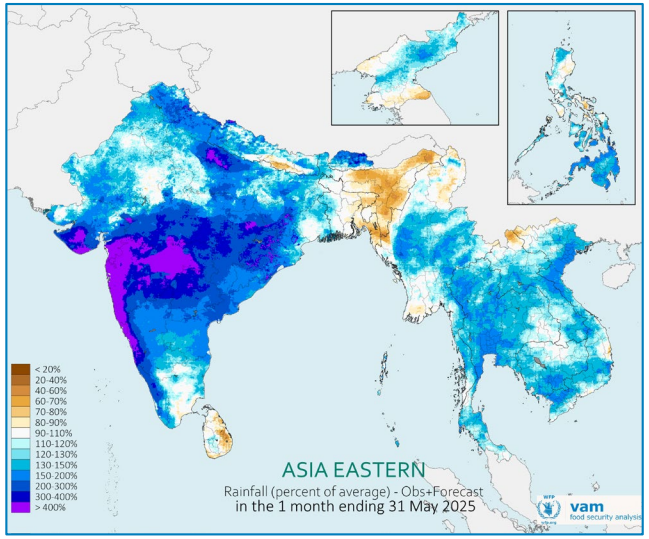
	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
South Asia					▬	▬	▬	▬	▬	▬		
SE Asia				▬	▬	▬	▬	▬	▬	▬	▬	

Favorable rainfall season expected

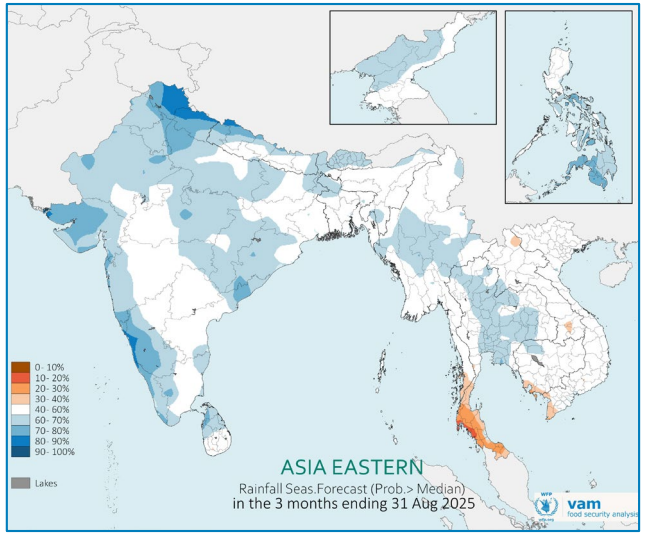
The monsoon season has begun across most of the region, bringing generally above-average rainfall, except in Bangladesh. Overall, conditions are favorable for crop development; however, the increased rainfall also raises the risk of localized flooding.

Rainfall is expected to be average to above average throughout most of the region during the monsoon season, supporting healthy crop growth. Nepal, western and central India, and Myanmar are likely to experience wetter-than-normal conditions over the next three months, which may trigger flooding. Similarly, much of India, along with Vietnam and Laos, is expected to see above-average rainfall from August to October. In Myanmar, flooding and extreme weather events could further complicate earthquake recovery efforts in the Sagaing region. Conversely, drier-than-normal conditions in the latter part of the season in Sri Lanka could negatively affect the outcomes of the second Yala season.

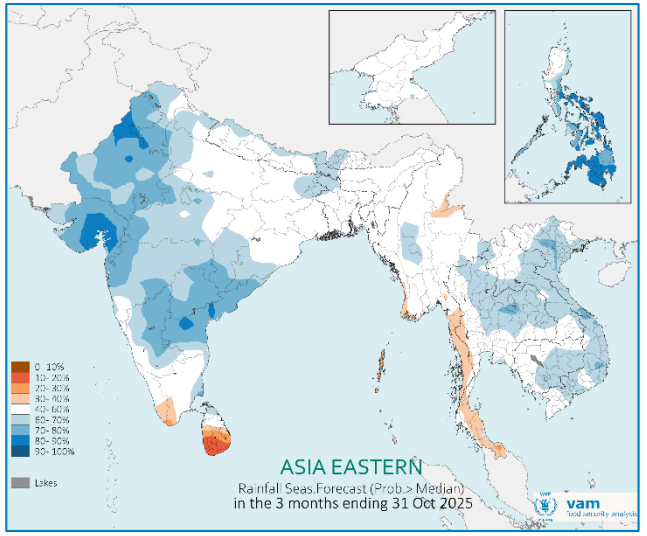
Following an intense 2024 cyclone season in the Philippines—marked by six major storms in six weeks, the outlook for 2025 predicts a near-normal number of tropical cyclones. Nevertheless, the risk of severe storms remains high, with flooding posing a particular threat in the southern regions throughout the season.



Observed and forecast rainfall for the 1-month **until 31 May 2025,** as the proportion of the long-term mean. Blue (orange) shades for likely wetter (drier) than usual conditions



Rainfall forecast for the 3-month **Jun-Aug 2025** as the likelihood of exceeding the long-term median. Blue (orange) shades for likely wetter (drier) than usual conditions



Rainfall forecast for the 3-month **Aug-Oct 2025** as the likelihood of exceeding the long-term median. Blue (orange) shades for likely wetter (drier) than usual conditions

WEST AFRICA

Seasonal Rainfall Calendar

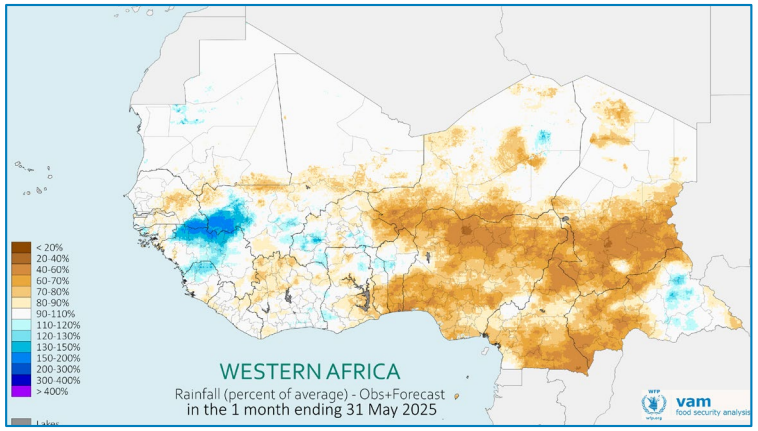
	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
Sahel					▬	▬	▬	▬	▬	▬		
Gulf of Guinea			▬	▬	▬	▬	▬	▬	▬	▬	▬	

Dry Conditions Loom Despite Seasonal Onset

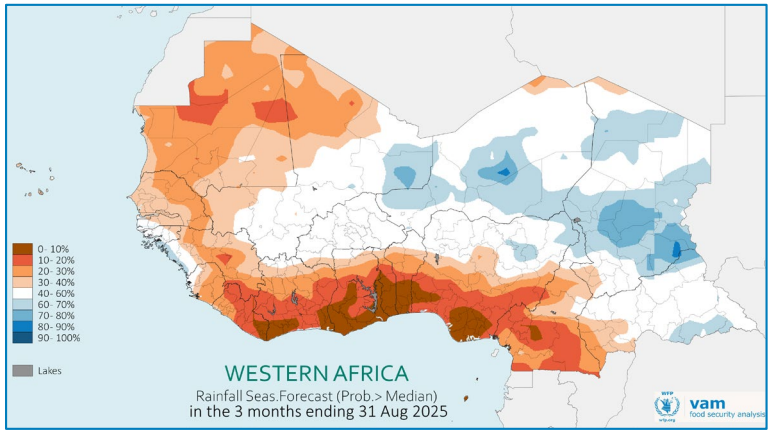
The rainy season has begun in the Gulf of Guinea countries, while the Sahel is preparing for its onset. While conditions are generally positive, some concerns remain regarding delayed rainfall in areas of Ghana, southern Togo and Benin, most of Nigeria, Cameroon, southern Chad and western Central African Republic.

Forecasts through August indicate a significant rainfall deficit across western areas and the Gulf of Guinea, including southern Nigeria and the Cameroon. This trend is expected to persist into the August–October period, except in Senegal, The Gambia and Guinea-Bissau. If these deficits materialize, they could severely impact crop production across much of the region.

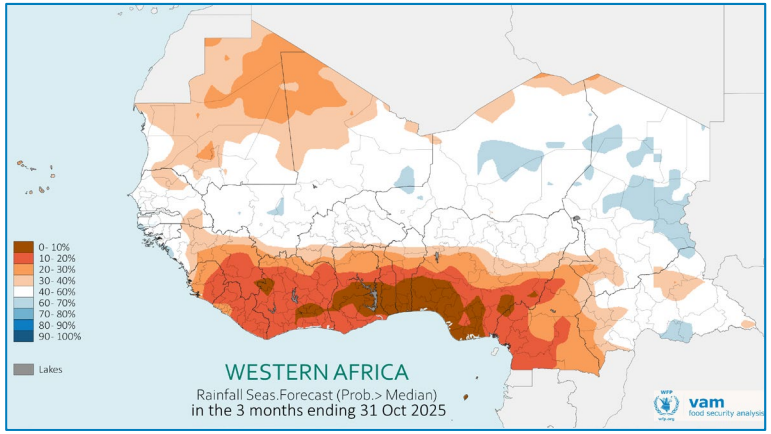
In contrast, above-average rainfall is expected in the central Sahel. This increases the likelihood of flooding, especially in flood-prone zones around Lake Chad and its tributary rivers.



Observed and forecast rainfall for the 1-month **until 31 May 2025** as as the proportion of the long-term mean. Blue (orange) shades for likely wetter (drier) than usual conditions



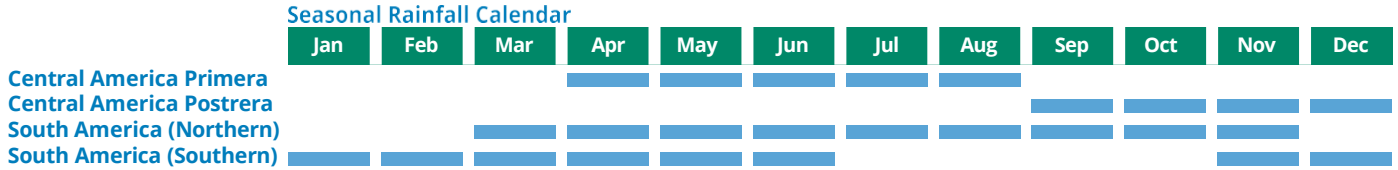
Rainfall forecast for the 3-month period **Jun-Aug 2025** as the likelihood of exceeding the long-term median. Blue (orange) shades for likely wetter (drier) than usual conditions.



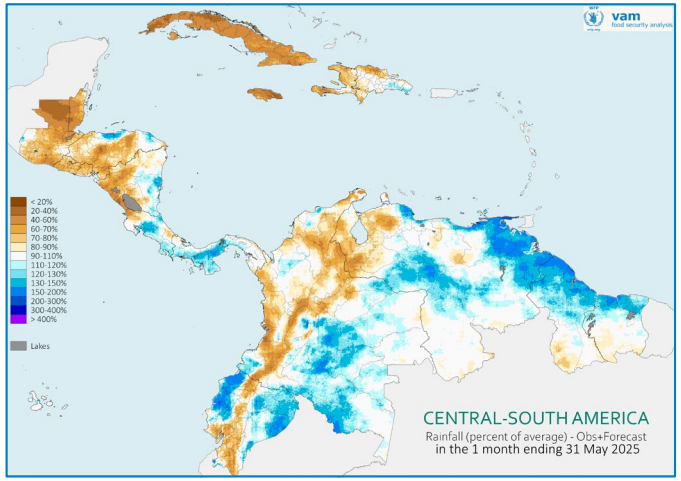
Rainfall forecast for the 3-month **Jul-Sep 2025** as the likelihood of exceeding the long-term median. Blue (orange) shades for likely wetter (drier) than usual conditions

LATIN AMERICA & THE CARIBBEAN

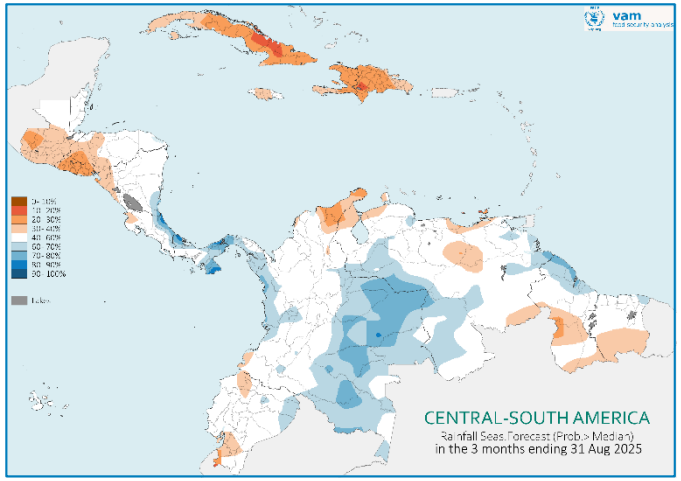
Seasonal Rainfall Calendar



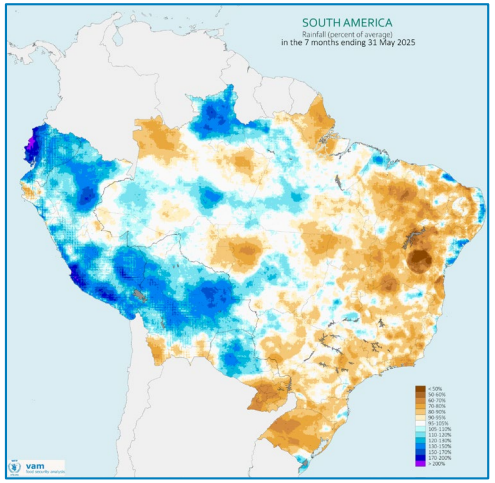
Drier Primera Season Forecast Raises Concerns



Observed and forecast rainfall for the 1-month **until 31 May 2025** as the proportion of the long-term mean. Blue (orange) shades for likely wetter (drier) than usual conditions



Rainfall forecast for **Jun-Aug 2025** as the likelihood of exceeding the long-term median. Blue (orange) shades for likely wetter (drier) than usual conditions



Observed and forecast rainfall from **November 2024 until 31 May 2025** as the proportion of the long-term mean. Blue (orange) shades for likely wetter (drier) than usual conditions

Central America and the Caribbean: The 2025 Primera rainy season began with below-average rainfall across the Caribbean, most of Guatemala, El Salvador, and Nicaragua, as well as parts of Honduras, Colombia, and Venezuela, raising concerns for planting and early crop growth, particularly in the Dry Corridor. Forecasts through August indicate continued below-average rainfall in the Caribbean and the Dry Corridor, which could reduce soil moisture during critical crop growth stages and hinder overall crop development. Looking ahead, the Atlantic hurricane season is set to start in June, with early forecasts indicating a likely above-average number of storms of storms due to warmer-than-normal sea surface temperatures in the tropical Atlantic.

Northern South America: The rainy season began with above-average rainfall across much of the region, including Colombia and Venezuela. While this benefits agricultural activities, it also increases the risk of localized flooding. Seasonal forecasts predict continued wet conditions through June to August, supporting crop growth but potentially causing flood-related disruptions.

Central and Southern South America: The 2024-2025 rainy season is nearing its end, with increased rainfall in Bolivia causing significant flooding that disrupted communities and agriculture. Meanwhile, eastern Brazil and Paraguay have experienced drier-than-average conditions.

METHODOLOGY

All satellite data (rainfall, vegetation index and land surface temperature) both current and historical are stored and processed at the WFP-HQ Humanitarian Data Cube AWS cloud system.

Rainfall: Primary dekadal data (CHIRPS) from Univ California St Barbara Climate Hazards Centre (*https://www.chc.ucsb.edu/data/chirps*)
Various accumulations are computed on a dekadal basis and anomalies derived relative to a 25 year-long mean (1994-2018). Rainfall charts from WFP Seasonal Explorer (*https://dataviz.vam.wfp.org/seasonal_explorer/rainfall_vegetation/visualizations*)

Land Surface Temperature: Primary data from MODIS-AQUA (NASA), cloud cleared and gap-filled, both daytime and nighttime images. Thermal amplitude derived from difference between the two. Long term averages 2002-2018 used to derive anomalies

Vegetation Index: Primary data from MODIS-AQUA and TERRA (NASA), cloud cleared and gap-filled. Long term averages 2002-2018 used to derive anomalies

Seasonal Forecast: *ECMWF seasonal forecasts* **(SEAS5)** | The forecast anomalies are presented as the probability of exceeding the median, indicating the likelihood that seasonal precipitation will be above the median of the 24-year climatological distribution. These anomalies are derived from a 51-member forecast ensemble and are calculated relative to a 24-year model climatology (based on a 25-member ensemble reforecast) spanning 1993–2016

Prepared by: Irene Ferrari, Gabriela Nobre, Diego Oliveira De Souza, Sirio Modugno, Michael Manalili, Giancarlo Pini

WFP World Food Programme

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